



Figure 5: GNOME 3 system settings



Figure 6: Activities - multitasking - Error

However, the problem with the developers and maintainers of GNOME is that they prioritise simplicity to the extent of bordering on the simplistic. This is exactly the case with GNOME 3.

The default dual-panel set-up of GNOME has been replaced by a single panel at the top, and a translucent, hidden notification area at the bottom. The top panel displays the clock in the centre. Clicking on the clock opens up an enhanced version of the standard calendar, which allows managing your events from the calendar itself (Figure 2).

The top-right portion of the panel contains the usual system management icons, including the Network Manager, the interface of which has changed somewhat in Lovelock. The networking menu displays a simplified version of the available networks, each with a representation of a toggle switch to the right (Figure 3). Simply clicking a network's entry turns it on or off. The network settings and systems settings windows have also changed (Figures 4 and 5, respectively); the latter was named Control Centre in previous versions of



Figure 7: GNOME 3 ABRT



Figure 8: GNOME 3 search

GNOME. The system settings window appears similar to the KDE one, but some important features have been removed from the user interface. One is that you can no longer customise the desktop theme using the built-in tools as easily as you could in previous versions. In fact, the default tools don't have any option to change the theme at all! Another UI change is that now there are no buttons present to minimise or maximise windows. To do that, either right-click the title bar and select the appropriate option, or use the keyboard to achieve the same effect—both much more cumbersome than the established norm.

The top panel's default menu has also been replaced by an *Activities* entry. You can either click on it, or point your mouse to the top-left corner of the screen. This opens up a screen with bookmarked applications on the left and those that are currently running in the middle, along with an *Applications* tab that lists all installed apps. However, the convenience of having the applications listed in groups (*Accessories, Internet, etc.*) is gone. The right side of the *Activities* screen shows the currently available virtual desktops. There is always one more than the number you are using, so you can keep creating as many as you like.

GNOME 3 is new software, and, just as was the case with KDE 4, this first version still has issues that need to be sorted out. For example, Figure 6 shows the *Activities* screen along with an error notification